MILITARY SPECIFICATION

HANDLE, ELECTRODE, ELECTROSURGERY

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a sterile, disposable, electrode handle with integral cord suitable for use with electrosurgical units.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-566	- Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	- Boxes, Setup.

MILITARY

MIL-S-36586	- Sterilization Test Strip Set, Bacterial Spore.

STANDARDS

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 6515

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the procurement document, the contractor shall furnish sample unit(s) for first article inspection and approval (see 4.1.2.1 and 6.2).

3.2 Materials. Materials used in the fabrication of the handles shall be as specified herein. All materials shall be of the highest quality and suitable in all respects for the intended purpose.

3.3 Design and construction. The electrode handle shall consist of a plastic handle and a cord.

3.3.1 Handle. The handle shall be fabricated of a suitable rigid plastic material. The handle shall not be less than 6 inches in length. The design and construction of the handle shall be such as to render it slip-resistant and permit easy gripping and handling during surgical procedures. The distal end of the handle shall contain a chuck to receive and hold all electrosurgical electrodes with 3/32 inch shank diameters. The color of the handle shall contrast with light blue and green surgical drapes and gowns. The handle shall be free of burs and sharp edges that would tear surgical gloves or cause other problems during use.

3.3.2 Cord. The cord shall not be less than 11 feet in length. The cord shall be lightweight and flexible and shall consist of a multi-strand copper wire, not less than No. 24 American Wire Gage, covered with suitable plastic insulation. The cord shall be neither so stiff that it impedes manipulation nor so flexible that it tangles easily. One end of the cord shall be secured within the handle; a suitable metal fitting shall be securely attached to the other end of the cord. The fitting shall be capable of being attached to the electrosurgical apparatus by means of an adapter. The cable insulation shall prevent excess current flow to medical personnel or the patient.

3.4 Performance. The cord connection within the handle and the cord connection to the metal fitting shall be capable of withstanding a pull of 9 pounds when tested as specified in 4.4.2 (The cord and handle shall be capable of withstanding without damage a potential of 6000 volts peak to peak at 60 Hz (see 4.4.1). The metal fitting at the end of the cord shall be capable of being inserted into and securely held by an electrosurgical unit mating adapter. A blade electrode with a shank diameter of .090 to .095 inch shall be capable of being inserted into a chuck of the handle using normal hand force without twisting when tested as specified in 4.4.3. The chuck shall securely hold the electrode in place within the handle. The total depth of the electrode shaft insertion within the handle shall not exceed 1-1/4 inches.

3.5 Sterility. The handles shall be sterile when tested with a biological indicator as specified in 4.4.4.

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3.5.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item identification.
b. National stock number.
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.).
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

3.5.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and simultaneously sterilized in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The handles shall be free from dust, dirt, oil, and other foreign matter. The handles shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.2.1 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection.
b. Quality conformance inspection.

4.1.2.1.1 First article inspection. First article inspection shall be performed on a handle when a first article sample is required (see 3.1). This inspection shall include examination of 4.3 and tests of 4.4.

4.1.2.1.2 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall include the examination of 4.3 and tests of 4.4.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the materials may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the Item Identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

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4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and table I. The unit of product for examination shall be the individual handle.

TABLE I. Sampling for examination

	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective units)
For visual examination		
Major defects	I	1.0
Minor defects	I	4.0
For dimensional examination	S-1	2.5

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 for an inspection level of S-3 and an AQL of 4.0. The acceptance number shall be zero for sterility test and dielectric strength test. The unit of product for tests shall be the individual handle. Sampling for sterility shall be as indicated in 4.4.4.

4.3 Examination. The handles shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.3.1 Classification of defects. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with the following classification of defects, as shown in table II. Examination shall not be restricted to the classified possible defects listed below.

TABLE II. Classification of defects

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Metal fitting not adequately secured to cord.
102	Handle not free of cracks, ruptures, and deformed sections.
103	Cord insulation not free of tear, cracks or breaks.
104	Ends of cord not free of exposed wire at points of entrance into handle or fitting.
105	Handle interior not free of obstructions to chuck component.
106	Unit not free of dirt, grease and foreign matter.
107	Cord not flexible as required.
Minor	
201	Handle and cord color does not contrast with light blue and green surgical drapes.

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4.3.2 Dimensional examination. The handles shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within the tolerance specified herein shall be classified as a defect.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Dielectric strength test. A potential of 6000 volts peak to peak at 60 Hz shall be applied between the handle and cord conductor and a metal plate or other suitable electrode. The handle and at least one foot of cord shall be in intimate contact with the metal plate. There shall be no evidence of breakdown with the potential applied for one minute.

4.4.2 Strain relief test. The handle shall be secured in place and a force gage attached to the cord. A straight pull shall be applied to the cord parallel to the long axis of the handle until a force of 9 pounds has been reached. The metal fitting on the end of the cord shall be secured and a force gage attached to the cord. A straight pull shall be applied to the cord until a force of 9 pounds is reached. Disconnection of the cord from either the handle or the fitting shall constitute failure of the test.

4.4.3 Electrode insertion test. The handle shall be grasped in one hand and a blade electrode shall be inserted into the chuck with the other hand. A straight force shall be used without twisting. Failure of the electrode to seat in and be securely held by the chuck shall constitute failure of this test. The necessity to use greater than normal hand force to seat the electrode shall constitute failure of the test. The depth of insertion of the shaft into the handle shall not exceed 1-1/4 inch.

4.4.4 Sterility test. The handles shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the U.S.P. for solids using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or

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paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in paragraph 4.4.4.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 for Type I Sterilization and 30 for Type II Sterilization including inoculated carrier and product test units.

4.4.4.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C
Dry Heat	B. stearothermophilus, or	55° - 65°C
	B. subtilis var.niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Radiation	B. pumilus	30° - 35°C

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

4.4.4.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in 4.4.4 Sterility test and 4.4.4.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. The method of sterilization will control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for as shown in 4.4.4.1. NOTE: When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the U.S.P.

4.4.4.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

4.4.4.4 Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the government shall be wihout a biological indicator and in accordance with the U.S.P.

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4.5 Examination for preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in table III. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. Examination for preparation for delivery

Examination	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Quantity	Quantity in interior packages and shipping containers not as specified.
Packaging and packing materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, tape improperly applied, or containers distorted.
Markings	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package containing twelve (12) handles as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1.1 Individual package. Each handle and cord assembly shall be packaged in a peel-back type plastic or combination paper plastic container capable of maintaining the sterility of its contents until manually opened. The peel-back design shall allow for removal of the container contents without danger of contamination.

5.1.1.1.2 Unit package. Each unit of issue shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566, PPP-B-676 or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure of box shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

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5.1.1.2 Level C. Each unit of issue shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Six (6) units of issue shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, class weather resistant, grade V3c. Closure, waterproofing and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Six (6) units of issue shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Handles shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Individual package. Each unit package shall be commercially identified.

5.3.2 Unit package. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Lot (control) number, contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown. The method sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, S-Steam, D-Dry Heat Sterilization) shall be shown following the level of packaging and the date of packaging. EXAMPLE "A-1/76-G". Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

5.3.3 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Lot (control) number and the method of sterilization, shall be shown as specified in 5.3.2.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The handle described by this specification is intended for use with 3/32 inch shank diameter electrodes during electrosurgical procedures.

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6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.1.2.1 and 6.3).

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be tested and approved under the appropriate provisions of 7-104.55 of the Armed Services Procurement Regulation. The contract or purchase order specifies the quantity, procedure for delivery and other specific instructions for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.4 This specification covers the following item of supply appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

NSN	Item Identification
6515-00-493-3768	HANDLE, ELECTRODE, ELECTROSURGERY, Plastic, Pencil Type, Disposable, 12s.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DSA-DM

Project No. 6515-1955

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-H-37242 - HANDLE, ELECTRODE, ELECTROSURGERY

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

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DATE

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